

## Reynolds “Renny” Hahamovitch

### Curriculum Vitae

he/him

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University of Michigan

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## EDUCATION

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PhD Candidate in History and Science & Technology Studies, University of Michigan  
Oct. 2026 (expected)

- Dissertation: “The Space Age: Technological Prophecy and the Political Economy of Big Tech”
- Committee Members: [Matthew Lassiter](#), [Perrin Selcer](#), [Joy Rohde](#), [Ronald Grigor Suny](#).
- Fields: Modern American History, Science & Technology Studies, Modern Russian History, Urban History and Class Theory

MA in History and Science & Technology Studies, University of Michigan, June 2025

MA in History with Concentration in Jewish Studies, Central European University 2018

- MA Thesis: “Toward the Jewish Revolution: Yiddish Anarchists in New York City, 1901–1906,” Winner of the Peter Hanak Prize for Best Thesis

BA - Summa Cum Laude, The College of William & Mary 2016

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## PUBLICATIONS

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### Journal Articles:

- Renny Hahamovitch, Réka Gál, Eleanor S. Armstrong, Asif Siddiqi, “[Dictators of the Future: Tech Oligarchy in Outer Space](#),” *Science as Culture* 35, no. 3, special edition “Tech Oligarchy Forum – Part 1,” Apr. 25, 2026.

### Book Chapters:

- “The Storm of Revolution: The *Freie Arbeiter Stimme* Reports on the Russian Revolution of 1905,” in [With Freedom in Our Ears: Histories of Jewish Anarchism](#), eds. Anna Elena Torres and Kenyon Zimmer (University of Illinois Press, 2023)

### Edited Primary Document Collections:

- Howard Brick, Renny Hahamovitch, Paul Le Blanc, Brian Whitener, eds. *Independent Marxism in the American Century, 1949–1965*, Volume 1, *Making Sense of New Realities*, Series: *Dissident Marxism in the United States* (In press: 2026, Brill and Haymarket Books)
- Howard Brick, Renny Hahamovitch, Paul Le Blanc, Brian Whitener, eds. *Independent Marxism in the American Century, 1949–1965*, Volume 2, *Re-emergence of Active Struggle and a New Left*, Series: *Dissident Marxism in the United States* (In press: 2026, Brill and Haymarket Books)
- Howard Brick, Renny Hahamovitch, Paul Le Blanc, Brian Whitener, eds. *Leftward Ho! Independent Marxism in the American Century, 1928–48*, Volume 1, *Capital's Crisis and Marxist Responses*, Series: *Dissident Marxism in the United States* (In press: 2026, Brill and Haymarket Books)
- Howard Brick, Renny Hahamovitch, Paul Le Blanc, Brian Whitener, eds. *Leftward Ho! Independent Marxism in the American Century, 1928–48*, Volume 2, *Culture, War, and the Crisis of Marxism*, Series: *Dissident Marxism in the United States* (In press: 2026, Brill and Haymarket Books)

#### **Public-facing publications:**

- “[The US military has used illegal spy balloons for decades](#),” *Lefteast* Apr. 4, 2023

#### **Translations**

- Hillel Solotaroff, “[Serious Questions](#),” from *Geklibene Shriften: Driter Band* (New York: Dr. H. Solotaroff Publication Committee, 1924), translated and published in [With Freedom in Our Ears: Histories of Jewish Anarchism](#) (University of Illinois Press, 2023).

#### **Articles in preparation:**

- “Orbital Vision and the Surveillant Sciences: The Co-Adoption of Remote Sensing Satellites by American Intelligence and Urban Planners”
- “Looking Down: The Production of Intelligence, Fact, and Fiction through Satellite Remote Sensing”
- “Space Age Blight: How Satellites Reinvented Urban Decay and Urban Redevelopment”
- “The Martini, A Labor History: Or, the postwar labor accord never existed, but if it did, it was a cocktail”

- “Cosmic Lunatics: Insanity, Masculinity, and Sexuality in Early Bioastronautics”

#### Press Interviews:

- Kaitlyn Gastineau, “[The Midwest’s Hidden Role in Space Exploration](#),” *Midstory*, Aug. 10, 2026
- James Dau, “[Funding the Final Frontier](#),” *Discover Rackham*, May 19, 2026

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### AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

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- |                                                                                                   |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| • History of Science Society, National Science Foundation Travel Grant                            | 2026      |
| • Research Fellow, Consortium for the History of Science, Technology, and Medicine                | 2025-2026 |
| • William T. Golden Research Fellow, American Philosophical Society ( <i>declined</i> )           | 2025-2026 |
| • University of Michigan Rackham Predoctoral Fellow                                               | 2025-2026 |
| • Smithsonian Predoctoral Fellowship ( <i>declined</i> )                                          | 2025-2026 |
| • University of Michigan Institute for the Humanities Graduate Student Fellow ( <i>declined</i> ) | 2025-2026 |
| • Resident Scholar at the Kluge Center, Library of Congress                                       | 2024-2025 |
| • NASA-AHA Fellow in Aerospace History                                                            | 2024-2025 |
| • Gerald R. Ford Dissertation Scholar Award in Honor of Robert M. Teeter (Ford Library)           | 2024      |
| • Ford Presidential Library Research Grant (Ford Library)                                         | 2024      |
| • Rackham Doctoral Intern Fellow with the National Humanities Alliance (Michigan)                 | 2024      |
| • Monterey Symposium Fellow                                                                       | 2024      |
| • Reed Fink Award in Southern Labor History (GSU)                                                 | 2023      |
| • Kosciuszko Foundation Tuition Scholarship                                                       | 2023      |
| • Summer FLAS Fellowship                                                                          | 2022      |
| • Academic Year FLAS Fellowship – Russian                                                         | 2021-2022 |
| • Summer FLAS Fellowship – Russian                                                                | 2021      |
| • Visegrad Fellow at the Open Society Archivum                                                    | 2018      |
| • Peter Hanak Prize for Best Master’s Thesis, CEU History Department                              | 2018      |
| • YIVO Uriel Weinreich Yiddish Summer Program Scholarship                                         | 2017      |
| • Ruth B. Fein Prize - American Jewish Historical Society                                         | 2017      |
| • CEU History Department Research Grant                                                           | 2017      |
| • CEU Jewish Studies Research Grant                                                               | 2017      |

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### INVITED TALKS

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- “Machinist on the Moon: The Dreams of Space Age Labor Relations and How They Failed,” NASA History Office Jan. 2026
- “Machinists on the Moon,” Kluge Center, Library of Congress Apr. 2025
- [“The Space Age on Strike,”](#) Georgia State University Special Collections Sep. 2024
- [“The ‘Time of Storms’ – New York Yiddish Anarchists from Kishinev to the 1905 Revolution,”](#) Yiddish Anarchism: New Scholarship on a Forgotten Tradition, YIVO Jan. 2019
- “Forward to the Future: Science and Science Fiction in the US and USSR,” Open Society Archivum Nov. 2018

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## CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

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- “Machinists on the Moon: The Hopes and Anxieties of the Space Age Worker,” Society for Social Studies of Science, Toronto, Canada Oct. 2026
- “Totalitarian Envy: How American Planners Copied Soviet Modernity,” Socialist Techno-Optimism and Governance of Economic Development, 1955-1991, Slavic Research Center, Sapporo, Japan Sep. 2026
- “From Social Discipline to Economic Discipline: Scientific Imperatives in American Bioastronautics,” History of Science Society, Edinburgh, Scotland Jul. 2026
- “Machinist on the Moon: The Hope and Anxieties of the Space Age Worker” in “Foreign Policy and Organized Labor During the Cold War: New History of a Pivotal Era,” AHA, Chicago Jan. 2026
- Chair, “Left Perspectives on Method III: Neoliberal/Cultural Turn in Histories of Socialism,” ASEEES, Washington DC Nov. 2025
- “The Rise and Fall of the Space Age: The Value of Technological Development and the Shape of the Future in American Capitalism and Soviet Communism,” Political Economy and Cultural Forms Conference, Jordan Center for Advanced Studies of Russia, NYU Apr. 2025
- [“Machinists on the Moon: The Anxieties and Hopes of the Space Age Worker,”](#) Cyborg Workers 2.0: The Past, Present and Future of Automated Labour – The Social and Environmental Costs of Big Tech, European Trade Union Institute, Brussels, Belgium Feb. 2025

- [“Machinists on the Moon: Unions, the Apollo Program, and the Failure of Space Age Labor Relations,”](#) Space Perceptions and Realities, UNIVERSEH, University of Toulouse Dec. 2024
- “Spy Satellites,” in “Senses & Assemblages,” Ensnaring Entanglements, U-M Science, Technology, and Society Symposium, University of Michigan Jan. 2024
- “Rocket City 1962 - The Space Age as Suburban Utopia,” in “Touching the Void: Tactile Geographies of Spaceports and New Space,” Royal Geographic Society, London Aug. 2024
- “Ideologies, Bodies, and Machines: Capitalism and Socialism Encounter in Early Bioastronautics,” in “Socialism or Barbarism II: Socialism and Science,” ASEES Nov. 2023
- “Planning for Collapse: NASA: Futurology, and the Loss of the Long-Term in the Apollo Era,” State Planning and Private Entrepreneurship in the 20<sup>th</sup> Century, Princeton Julis-Rabinowitz Center for Public Policy & Finance Nov. 2023
- “Planning for Progress: NASA, Futurology, and the Loss of the Long-Term in the Apollo Era,” Graduate Research in STS Conference (GRISTS), Harvard Kennedy School Oct. 2023
- “Future without Limits, Colonialism without Guilt: The L5 Society and the Dreams of Utopian Space Capitalism,” Intentional Communities: Real Utopias in History Conference, Transatlantic Network for the Study of Utopias, HISTOPIA research group, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid Oct. 2021
- “The Storm of Revolution – Jewish Anarchists in New York City and the 1905 Russian Revolution,” Global Labor Migration Network Conference: Past and Present– International Institute for Social History in Amsterdam Jun. 2019
- “Reconciling the Space Race and Space Age: Soviet and American Imaginations of the Future,” 2nd Science Fiction and Communism Conference, American University of Bulgaria Mar. 2019

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## ACADEMIC ORGANIZING

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- Coordinator, “Against Stagnation: Reform and Flexibility in Late Socialism,” Zoom Panel, Black Sheep Society 2026

- Coordinator, “Black Sheep Society Symposium III; [Remembering Revisionism with Sheila Fitzpatrick, Anna Krylova, Ronald Suny, and Lewis Siegelbaum](#)” 2025
- Co-coordinator, “[Learning from the Wise: Black Sheep Symposium II](#)” 2024
- Co-coordinator, “[Black Sheep Society Symposium I: The Necessity of the Black Sheep](#)” 2024
- Co-coordinator “[Ensnaring Entanglements](#)” University of Michigan STS Symposium 2024
- Organizer, Panel “[Socialism or Barbarism II: Socialism and Science](#),” ASEES 2023
- Co-organizer – “[Insurgents and Intellectuals: Thought and Practice on the Left in US History](#),” University of Michigan, History Department, Oct. 2023
- Co-organizer – The Movement of Labor: Migration, Racialization, and Class Struggle on Europe’s Southeastern Periphery – A convergence of activists and academics hosted by LeftEast and Solidarity Network, Georgia – Tbilisi 2023
- Assistant – “[A Hit Parade of Historical Turns: From a Russian Perspective](#)” 2022

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## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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### University of Michigan:

- Russia/USSR in the 20<sup>th</sup> and 21<sup>st</sup> Centuries: War, Revolution, and Reform (Hist 434/PolSci 434), TA for [Ronald Grigor Suny](#)
- American Addictions (Hist 305/PolSci 321) TA for [Henry Cowles](#)

### Lauder Javne School (Budapest, Hungary):

- Jewish History: Jews, Europe, and the City, 1500 to the Present, Primary Instructor

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## COURSES IN PREPARATION

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- Do Machines Dream? Or, the History of the Future

- The Space Age: American Technology and the Vertical Empire
- Modern U.S. Survey
- Modern Russian/Soviet Survey
- Theoretical Approaches to Technology and Society (grad seminar)

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## OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Media:

- Acting Editor – [LeftEast](#) 2022-24

### Academic:

- Research Assistant for [Howard Brick](#) 2020-
- Rackham Doctoral Intern Fellow, [National Humanities Alliance](#) 2024

### Publishing:

- Assistant Managing Editor at Central European University Press 2019

### Copy Editor and Proofreader:

- Central European University Press 2017-22
- LABOR: Studies in Working-Class History of the Americas 2014-19
- LeftEast 2019-24
- Yulia Karpova, *Comradely Objects* (Manchester University Press) 2019

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## DEPARTMENT SERVICE

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- Co-coordinator – Science and Technology Studies Rackham Interdisciplinary Workshop 2021 – 2023

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## ACADEMIC MEMBERSHIPS

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- American Historical Association (AHA)
- Organization of American Historians (OAH)
- History of Science Society (HSS)
- Society for the History of Technology (SHOT)

- Society for Social Studies of Science (4S)
- Labor and Working-Class History Association (LAWCHA)
- Association for Slavic, Eastern European, and Eurasian Studies (ASEEES)
- Economic History Association (EHA)

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## **LANGUAGE EXPERIENCE**

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- Native: English
- Advanced: Yiddish
- Advanced: Russian